3. **Water Resources and energy cooperation**

- A three–tier mechanism established in 2008, to discuss all bilateral issues relating to cooperation in water resources and hydropower.
- Nepal has many fast flowing rivers and its terrain makes it ideal for hydroelectric power generation. Nepal's installed capacity is less than 700 MW while it has a potential to generate over 80,000 MW.
- A 900 megawatts hydropower project Arun III has been launched recently.
- An Agreement on "Electric Power Trade, Cross-border Transmission Interconnection and Grid Connectivity" was signed between India and Nepal in 2014.
- A Joint Technical Team (JTT) has been formed for preparation of long-term integrated transmission plan covering projects up to 2035.

4. **Defense Cooperation**

- The Gorkha Regiments of the Indian Army are raised partly by recruitment from hill districts of Nepal.
- Since 1950, India and Nepal have been awarding Army Chiefs of each other with the honorary rank of General.
- Bilateral defense cooperation includes assistance to Nepal Army in its modernization through provision of equipment and training.
- About 250 training slots are provided every year for training of Nepal Army personnel in various Indian Army Training institutions.
- India and Nepal conducted a joint military exercise, Surya Kiran XIII from May 30 to June 12 in Uttarakhand this year.

5. **Infrastructure and connectivity**

- Recently a MoU was signed on Raxaul-Kathmandu railway line. A postal highway project is also being undertaken.
- Both the countries are also focused on inland waterways connectivity.

6. **People to People cooperation**

- The Governments of India and Nepal have signed three sister-city agreements for twinning of Kathmandu-Varanasi, Lumbini-Bodhgaya and Janakpur-Ayodhya.
- Direct bus service between Janakpur and Ayodhya under Ramayan Circuit under Swadesh Darshan Scheme was launched.
- Nepal and India share Hindu and Buddhist heritage. Lumbini, the birth place of Lord Buddha is in Nepal while Bodh Gaya where he attained enlightenment is in India. Similarly the hindu pilgrimage places are also spread in both countries.

Activity



Courtesy: The Hindu cartoon

Give two reasons why King Gyanendra refused to accept the transition from a feudal autocracy and monarch to a democratic republic.

Challenges

1. **Border issues:**

- The two major areas of dispute at Susta and Kalapani (India-China-Nepal tri-junction).
- Countries agreed to start talks at the

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